

career. Life is all about doing something to reap benefits in the future. So all of us are in the investment game. However, it means different things to different people. People invest in:

- large families so that when they grow old, their children can take care of them,
- education, to ensure job security and a comfortable life,
- land and crops, in order to fend for themselves and their families,
- small families, to provide a good standard of education and living for their child,
- their health, by exercising regularly and eating a balanced diet,
- charitable works, to serve the poor and the needy, and
- external assets like real estate, shares in listed companies, gold, silver, etc., so that they can fall back upon them in tough times.

Thus we have a lot of people doing different things in the name of investing. This makes the subject of investing very complex.



Investment Products

These come in the form of stocks, bonds, mutual funds, real estate, precious metals, insurance, commodities, etc. The reason people choose one form or another is distinct as each is designed to satisfy a particular need.

- Stocks offer dividends and capital appreciation.
- Bonds are much safer than stocks and offer a safe return on the money invested.
- Mutual funds may be seen as less risky than stocks.
- Investment in real estate could be for capital appreciation, to earn rent or for self-accommodation.
- Insurance is used as a security.